NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY PATNA
MID SEMESTER EXAMINATION, JANUARY-JUNE 2025

Program: B.Tech CSE & DD
Semester: 2nd
Course Code: Communicative English
Course Name: HS24101
Branch: B. Tech CSE 1, 2 & 3
Full Marks: 22.5
Duration of Examination: 2 Hours

Instructions: Answer all the questions in your own words. Faculty-Dr. Zeeshan Ali

1. Examine the role of soft skills and hard skills in shaping professional success. How can a well-balanced combination of both enhance workplace performance and career growth? Evaluate their significance and justify your response with real-world examples. (7.5 marks) CO1

2. Describe the key characteristics of an effective listener in a professional setting. Analyse how these qualities enhance leadership skills and contribute to overall organisational growth. Develop a well-structured argument by integrating relevant workplace examples. (7.5 marks) CO4

3. Prepare a précis of the passage given below. (7.5 marks) CO7

With the increasing reliance on technology, cybersecurity has become an essential concern for individuals, businesses, and governments. It refers to the protection of digital systems, networks, and data from cyber threats such as hacking, phishing, and malware. Cybercriminals exploit weaknesses in software and human behaviour to gain unauthorised access, steal data, or disrupt services.

Phishing remains a significant threat where attackers trick users into sharing sensitive information by impersonating legitimate sources. Malware, including ransomware and spyware, can compromise security by locking devices or stealing confidential information. Such attacks affect banking, healthcare, and even national security, leading to severe financial and operational losses.

To counter cyber threats, organisations and governments implement security measures such as firewalls, encryption, and multi-factor authentication. Regular software updates and cybersecurity awareness programmes also play a crucial role in mitigating risks. As cybercriminals use advanced technologies, artificial intelligence (AI) and the Internet of Things (IoT) introduce new vulnerabilities. AI-driven attacks can bypass traditional security systems, while poorly secured IoT devices pose serious risks to data privacy.

Cybersecurity is not only a technical concern but a shared responsibility. Individuals must adopt best practices, such as using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and keeping software updated. Governments must enforce stringent cybersecurity laws, while businesses should invest in advanced security infrastructure. Ethical hacking also helps identify vulnerabilities before criminals exploit them.

In today's digital world, prioritising cybersecurity is essential for protecting sensitive information, ensuring privacy, and maintaining trust in online systems. A collaborative approach is necessary to stay ahead of cyber threats and build a secure digital environment for the future.
